

VISWANATH M

Senior Network & Security Architect

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19+	SD-WAN	Zero Trust	AI-Driven
Years in Enterprise Networking & Security	vManage / vSmart / vBond Architecture	ISE, TrustSec & Segmentation	Claude, Cursor AI & n8n Automation

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Senior Network & Security Architect with 19+ years of experience designing and operating large-scale enterprise, WAN, and data center networks. Recognized for translating complex, multi-site connectivity and security requirements into resilient, automated, zero-trust architectures. Deep expertise in Software-Defined Networking (SDN), Cisco SD-WAN, Cisco DNA Center (DNAC), and Cisco Identity Services Engine (ISE), with a strong track record in intent-based networking, policy-driven segmentation, and hybrid WAN transformation. Skilled in Python, Ansible, REST APIs, and Infrastructure as Code (IaC), and an early adopter of AI-assisted engineering (Claude, Cursor AI) and workflow orchestration (n8n) to accelerate automation, configuration validation, and day-2 operations, always with human-in-the-loop change control. Known for clear architecture documentation (HLD/LLD), calm incident leadership, and mentoring engineering teams through complex transformations.

CORE SKILLS

Routing & Switching	MPLS, BGP, OSPF, EIGRP, VRF, VXLAN EVPN, LAN/WAN/Data Center design, QoS
SDN & Automation	Cisco SD-WAN (vManage/vSmart/vBond), Cisco DNA Center, SDA Fabric, ZTP, Intent-Based Networking
Security & NAC	Cisco ISE, 802.1X, MAB, TrustSec/SGT, dACL, Posture, TACACS+, Firewalls, Site-to-Site & Remote-Access VPN, Zero Trust
Automation & IaC	Python, Ansible, Jinja2, REST APIs, Webhooks, Git, CI/CD for network code
AI & Orchestration	Claude, Cursor AI, n8n, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Prompt Engineering, LLM-assisted config analysis
Cloud & Connectivity	Direct Internet Access (DIA), SaaS/cloud optimization, hybrid MPLS/broadband/LTE transport
Governance & Leadership	HLD/LLD, Vendor Management, Risk Management, ISO 27001-aligned controls, Stakeholder Alignment, Team Mentoring

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed Cisco SD-WAN across global branch locations, including zero-touch branch provisioning (ZTP), cutting new-site turn-up time significantly.
- Implemented Cisco DNA Center for campus automation and SDA fabric deployment; integrated DNAC with ISE for policy-based segmentation.
- Deployed Cisco ISE NAC for wired, wireless, and VPN access control, strengthening the organization's access security posture.
- Automated network provisioning and changes using Python and Ansible, reducing manual configuration effort and human error.
- Implemented intent-based networking policies for user segmentation, improving compliance with internal security standards.
- Recognized internally as a go-to architect for complex, cross-functional network transformation initiatives.

SD-WAN EXPERTISE

- Designed Cisco SD-WAN architecture using vManage, vSmart, and vBond controllers for centralized orchestration.
- Deployed application-aware routing policies using SLA metrics (latency, jitter, packet loss).
- Implemented secure segmentation using VPN/VRF overlays across the WAN fabric.
- Designed hybrid WAN architectures integrating MPLS, broadband, and LTE transport; configured Direct Internet Access (DIA) for SaaS and cloud optimization.
- Implemented centralized and localized data policies for traffic steering and security.
- Designed high-availability SD-WAN topology with dual WAN edge redundancy.
- Integrated SD-WAN with the security stack (firewalls, cloud security); optimized performance using QoS, traffic shaping, and application visibility.

CISCO ISE EXPERTISE

- Designed and deployed Cisco ISE for enterprise NAC; implemented 802.1X (wired/wireless) and MAB for non-802.1X devices.
- Implemented dynamic VLAN assignment and downloadable ACLs (dACL); configured device profiling and posture assessment.
- Designed TrustSec architecture using Security Group Tags (SGT) and Zero Trust segmentation via ISE policy enforcement.
- Integrated ISE with Active Directory, DNAC, VPN, and firewalls; implemented Guest access and BYOD onboarding.
- Configured TACACS+ device administration using ISE.

AI-DRIVEN NETWORK AUTOMATION

- Built **n8n** workflows to orchestrate network operations, triggered by ITSM tickets, monitoring alerts, or webhooks, calling vManage, DNAC, and ISE REST APIs for provisioning, inventory sync, and compliance checks.
- Used **Claude** to generate, review, and document Python and Ansible automation for SD-WAN, DNAC, and ISE, accelerating script development and improving code quality.
- Leveraged **Cursor AI** as an AI-native IDE to build and refactor network automation codebases (Ansible roles, Jinja2 templates, API clients) with consistent standards.
- Implemented LLM-assisted configuration analysis: summarizing config diffs, flagging deviations from golden templates, and drafting change-impact summaries for CAB review.
- Automated ISE and DNAC policy workflows (SGT/authorization policy updates, device onboarding) through n8n pipelines with approval gates, logging, and rollback.
- Built AI-assisted troubleshooting workflows that enrich syslog/telemetry alerts with device context via API and produce root-cause hypotheses and remediation steps to reduce MTTR.
- Auto-generated HLD/LLD documentation, runbooks, and change records from configs and design inputs using Claude.
- Established AI guardrails for network operations: read-only API scopes, human approval for production changes, secrets management, and data sanitization before LLM use.

NOTABLE PROJECTS

- **Global SD-WAN Transformation:** Migrated legacy MPLS branch network to Cisco SD-WAN with hybrid transport, improving application performance and resilience while lowering WAN operating cost.
- **Zero-Trust Access Rollout:** Led enterprise-wide Cisco ISE deployment introducing identity-based, policy-driven access control across wired, wireless, and VPN.
- **Network Automation Modernization:** Introduced a Python/Ansible/n8n automation stack augmented with AI tooling (Claude, Cursor AI) to standardize provisioning and compliance workflows across the network team.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Infogain India Pvt. Ltd.

IT Manager / Senior Network & Security Architect | Dec 2009 – Present

- Led enterprise LAN, WAN, MPLS, and data center architecture across multi-site environments.
- Architected VRF-based segmentation and secure inter-VRF communication models.
- Designed and implemented VXLAN EVPN overlays with integrated firewall inspection.
- Delivered secure site-to-site and remote-access VPN architectures with high availability.
- Led enterprise Cisco ISE deployment enabling identity-based access control.
- Architected firewall clustering, WAN redundancy, and failover strategies.
- Introduced AI-augmented automation practices (Claude, Cursor AI, n8n) across the network team, standardizing reusable workflows for provisioning, compliance validation, and incident triage.
- Owned the architecture lifecycle: HLD/LLD, vendor coordination, risk management, and stakeholder alignment.
- Mentored junior network engineers on automation practices and architecture design principles.

Mindlogicx Infotech Limited

Assistant Manager – Infrastructure & Security | Aug 2008 – Dec 2009

- Managed enterprise infrastructure operations, implemented ISO 27001-aligned controls, and strengthened monitoring, backup, and compliance frameworks.
- Coordinated with cross-functional teams to maintain infrastructure uptime and audit readiness.

Affiliated Computer Services India Pvt. Ltd.

Technical Project Analyst | Feb 2007 – Aug 2008

- Managed cross-functional technical projects, performed root cause analysis, and ensured structured project execution and closure.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- [Add relevant certifications, e.g. Cisco CCNP/CCIE Enterprise or Security, Cisco SD-WAN Specialist, CISSP, ITIL]
- Continuous upskilling in AI-assisted engineering tools (Claude, Cursor AI) and automation orchestration (n8n).

EDUCATION

- MBA – Information Technology
- B.Sc. – Computer Science

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Tools & Platforms:** Cisco vManage/vSmart/vBond, DNA Center, ISE, Ansible Tower/AWX, Postman, Git, n8n, Claude, Cursor AI.
- **Working Style:** Comfortable owning architecture end-to-end — design, documentation, stakeholder alignment, and hands-on implementation.
- **Availability:** Open to architecture, consulting, and leadership roles in enterprise networking and network security.
- References available upon request.